



ISLAM

Islam originated in the Middle East in the 7th century and is still the dominant religion of the region. Muslims, the followers of Islam, believe in one God, Allah, and in Mohammad, his prophet. Mohammad was born in Mecca, in modern-day Saudi Arabia. The Muslims' holy book is the Koran, which contains Allah's teachings as revealed to Mohammad.

A devout Muslim reading the Koran

Dubai, United Arab Emirates



CITIES

The Middle East has some of the most rapidly growing cities in the world. This is because of the enormous wealth brought to the region by the discovery of oil and by the growth in population. These large cities are built along the lines of many modern cities in Western countries, with high-rise apartment and office buildings of glass, steel, and concrete.